started in the past and continues till the present with a likelihood of continuing further.

Task: Complete the sentences using the verbs given in brackets.

i) We _____in this house for 20 years. (live)

ii) I _____this computer for three years. (use)

iii) The workers _____ higher wages for a long time. (demand)

iv) It _____ since yesterday. (rain)

v) He _____ in the garden since morning. (work)

e. The Past

Read the following biography of Bharathidasan.

Kanagasabhai Subburathinam, popularly **called** Bharathidasan, was a twentieth century Tamil poet. In Bharathiyar's memory, he **wrote** in the pseudonym Bharathidasan. He was a rationalist who **handled** social issues. His writings **served** as a catalyst for the growth of the Dravidian movement. He **received** the Sahitya Akademi Award in 1970. The Tamil Nadu state government **established** the prestigious Bharathidasan Award, to be given away each year to talented Tamil poets.

Notice the Past Form of verbs used to describe the life history of a person. This form is used to refer to events that took place in the past.

Task: Write a report about your sports day in a paragraph using the hints given below.

i) Welcoming the Chief Guest

ii) Prayer

iii) Welcome Address

iv) March Past

v) Lighting the torch

vi) Oath taking

vii) Declaring the Sports Meet open

viii) Events

ix) Closing March Past

x) Report by Physical Director

xi) Chief Guest Speech

xii) Prize Distribution

xiii) Vote of Thanks

f. The Past Continuous Tense

At about nine in the morning, a group of children **were waiting** near the old house at the Lawyers Extension for their school bus to arrive.

They **were chatting** excitedly, when suddenly a boy called out "Bus, bus". Soon the bunch **was screaming** in delight to see their driver, who **was parking** the vehicle parallel to the platform.

The children formed a neat line and **were shouting** gleefully, as they boarded the bus.

Task:

Look at the pictures given and write five sentences about them using the past continuous tense.

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